Central Ideas and Details — Part 1

Information and Ideas · Reading and Writing · 69 questions

1.1 b6c6791d-a741-4cf2-a375-015d06958e65 · Easy

NASA's *Cassini* probe has detected an unusual wobble in the rotation of Mimas, Saturn's smallest moon. Using a computer model to study Mimas's gravitational interactions with Saturn and tidal forces, geophysicist Alyssa Rhoden and colleagues have proposed that this wobble could be due to a liquid ocean moving beneath the moon's icy surface. The researchers believe other moons should be examined to see if they too might have oceans hidden beneath their surfaces.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. Rhoden and colleagues were the first to confirm that several of Saturn's moons contain hidden oceans.

B. Research has failed to identify signs that there is an ocean hidden beneath the surface of Mimas.

C. Rhoden and colleagues created a new computer model that identifies moons with hidden oceans without needing to analyze the moons' rotation.

D. Research has revealed that an oddity in the rotation of Mimas could be explained by an ocean hidden beneath its surface.

1.2 41a03d69-174b-43a7-be54-96a52f28ee57 · Easy

Scrapbooks of saved fabric pieces were commonly kept by women in the nineteenth-century United States, but few are as meticulously detailed as Hannah Ditzler Alspaugh's work. Alongside each piece of fabric, Alspaugh recorded intimate memories, such as dressmaking with her sister. Additionally, she listed the prices and how she used the fabric. Historians note that by representing fifty years of changing textures, patterns, and dress styles, the scrapbook is a record of nineteenth-century textiles and dressmaking as well as Alspaugh's life.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. Alspaugh inspired other women to save pieces of fabric in scrapbooks and provide historical records of nineteenth-century fashions in the United States.

B. Historians rely on fabric scrapbooks to understand how fashions changed throughout the nineteenth-century United States.

C. Fabric scrapbooks were a popular hobby for many women in the nineteenth-century United States.

D. Alspaugh's scrapbook provides a detailed account of her life and historical record of fashion trends in the nineteenth-century United States.

1.3 92264ffd-d9d5-4e5f-b423-5c7112ae7b48 · Easy

It has long been thought that the original author of the US Pledge of Allegiance was Francis Bellamy, who said that he wrote the pledge one evening in August of 1892. But a historian recently discovered a newspaper article that was published several months before August 1892. The article describes students reciting the same pledge that Bellamy claims he first wrote in August. This means that Bellamy may not have created the pledge after all.

Based on the text, what piece of knowledge about the Pledge of Allegiance has recently become uncertain?

A. How many changes were made to the pledge in the 1900s

B. The identity of the person who first wrote the pledge

C. The name of the newspaper that first published the pledge

D. Which part of the pledge students liked best in 1892

1.4 5a6ab4a7-204c-4a63-93a5-15775a471395 · Easy

The following text is from Edith Nesbit's 1902 novel *Five Children and It*. Five young siblings have just moved with their parents from London to a house in the countryside that they call the White House.

> It was not really a pretty house at all; it was quite ordinary, and mother thought it was rather inconvenient, and was quite annoyed at there being no shelves, to speak of, and hardly a cupboard in the place. Father used to say that the ironwork on the roof and coping was like an architect's nightmare. But the house was deep in the country, with no other house in sight, and the children had been in London for two years, without so much as once going to the seaside even for a day by an excursion train, and so the White House seemed to them a sort of Fairy Palace set down in an Earthly Paradise.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. Although their parents believe the house has several drawbacks, the children are enchanted by it.

B. The children don't like the house nearly as much as their parents do.

C. Each member of the family admires a different characteristic of the house.

D. The house is beautiful and well built, but the children miss their old home in London.

1.5 f4d5a3e3-3526-4403-9a50-294a663640d4 · Easy

Archaeologist Veronica Waweru visited the Lewa Wildlife Conservancy in Kenya. While exploring there, Waweru noticed many rows of shallow pits carved into stone. Waweru believed the pits could have been used as game boards to play ancient versions of mancala, a two-person strategy game that is still popular today. Some of the more recent pits were carved on top of older pits. This led Waweru to think that the game was played at the site for a long time.

According to the text, why does Waweru think that mancala was played at the site for a long time?

A. Some of the newer pits were carved on top of the older pits.

B. She noticed many rows of shallow pits carved into stone.

C. She discovered the pits at the Lewa Wildlife Conservancy.

D. Some of the pits were shallow and others were quite deep.

1.6 c0a0b3da-d759-43c9-8b98-ede924bab5da · Easy

The following text is adapted from Frances Hodgson Burnett's 1911 novel *The Secret Garden*. Mary, a young girl, recently found an overgrown hidden garden.

> Mary was an odd, determined little person, and now she had something interesting to be determined about, she was very much absorbed, indeed. She worked and dug and pulled up weeds steadily, only becoming more pleased with her work every hour instead of tiring of it. It seemed to her like a fascinating sort of play.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. Mary hides in the garden to avoid doing her chores.

B. Mary is getting bored with pulling up so many weeds in the garden.

C. Mary is clearing out the garden to create a space to play.

D. Mary feels very satisfied when she's taking care of the garden.

1.7 ddcb39de-3d58-4bc6-a2a2-0acfe8437055 · Easy

Xin Wang and colleagues have discovered the earliest known example of a flower bud in a 164-million-year-old plant fossil in China. The researchers have named the new species *Florigerminis jurassica.* They believe that the discovery pushes the emergence of flowering plants, or angiosperms, back to the Jurassic period, which occurred between 145 million and 201 million years ago.

According to the text, how old was the fossil that Wang and colleagues discovered?

A. 150 million years old

B. 145 million years old

C. 164 million years old

D. 201 million years old

1.8 c64a25c2-99cd-485d-b5c7-8c0aa9f6ce6f · Easy

Scent is tightly interwoven with our daily lives, often evoking significant memories and important social events. This connection is of growing interest to archaeologists who hope to use it to better understand ancient rituals, trade, social hierarchies, and medicine. Although the speed at which odor molecules dissipate makes identifying ancient scents challenging, advancements in biomolecular technologies show promise in unlocking ancient aromas from preserved artifacts. Archaeological studies making use of these advancements may provide new insights into past societies.

According to the text, what is one reason some archaeologists are interested in recovering scents from ancient artifacts?

A. They are investigating whether people’s sense of smell has declined in recent centuries.

B. They believe the scents could illuminate important aspects of ancient life.

C. They think that ancient scents would be enjoyable to people today.

D. They hope to develop new medicines using ancient scent molecules.

1.9 5a912020-242d-4bc0-96dd-c00c12736562 · Easy

Shimmering is a collective defense behavior that researchers have observed in giant honeybee colonies. When shimmering, different groups of bees flip their bodies up and down in what looks like waves. This defense is initiated when hornets hover near a colony, serving to deter the hornets from approaching the bees. Researchers hypothesize that this behavior is a specialized defense response to hornets, as it is not observed when other, larger predators approach the colony.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. Researchers are unsure how giant honeybees defend against predators larger than hornets.

B. Researchers think that shimmering in giant honeybees is a specific defense against hornets.

C. Hornets are known to be the main predator of giant honeybees.

D. Several different species of insects use shimmering to defend against hornets.

1.10 f5da42be-3aec-4b8c-8203-d3effdb98683 · Easy

The following text is from Beatrice Harraden's 1894 novel *Ships that Pass in the Night*.

> In an old second-hand bookshop in London, an old man sat reading Gibbon's *History of Rome*. He did not put down his book when the postman brought him a letter. He just glanced indifferently at the letter, and impatiently at the postman. Zerviah Holme did not like to be interrupted when he was reading Gibbon; and as he was always reading Gibbon, an interruption was always regarded by him as an insult.

Based on the text, how did Zerviah Holme most likely feel when the letter was delivered?

A. He felt relieved because he had been expecting an important letter.

B. He felt excited because the letter was from a good friend.

C. He felt sad because the postman did not stop to talk with him before leaving.

D. He felt annoyed because he was interrupted while reading his favorite author.

1.11 e807e311-35fb-41ba-a60b-feebda8114ab · Easy

The following text is adapted from Ann Petry's 1946 novel *The Street*. Lutie lives in an apartment in Harlem, New York.

> The glow from the sunset was making the street radiant. The street is nice in this light, [Lutie] thought. It was swarming with children who were playing ball and darting back and forth across the sidewalk in complicated games of tag. Girls were skipping double dutch rope, going tirelessly through the exact center of a pair of ropes, jumping first on one foot and then the other.

©1946 by Ann Petry

Which choice best describes what is happening in the text?

A. Lutie is observing the appearance of the street at a particular time of day and the events occurring on it.

B. Lutie is annoyed by the noise of children playing games on her street.

C. Lutie is puzzled by the rules of certain children's games.

D. Lutie is spending time alone in her apartment because she doesn't want to interact with her neighbors.

1.12 b91c15bb-00cb-4f87-bb8f-d086405bf9d0 · Easy

In 2014, Amelia Quon and her team at NASA set out to build a helicopter capable of flying on Mars. Because Mars's atmosphere is only one percent as dense as Earth's, the air of Mars would not provide enough resistance to the rotating blades of a standard helicopter for the aircraft to stay aloft. For five years, Quon's team tested designs in a lab that mimicked Mars's atmospheric conditions. The craft the team ultimately designed can fly on Mars because its blades are longer and rotate faster than those of a helicopter of the same size built for Earth.

According to the text, why would a helicopter built for Earth be unable to fly on Mars?

A. Because Mars and Earth have different atmospheric conditions

B. Because the blades of helicopters built for Earth are too large to work on Mars

C. Because the gravity of Mars is much weaker than the gravity of Earth

D. Because helicopters built for Earth are too small to handle the conditions on Mars

1.13 3a04d20b-5096-450a-b14c-b8e956fd9b8c · Easy

The following text is from Laila Lalami's 2019 novel *The Other Americans*. The narrator is a member of her middle school's jazz band.

> One day the jazz band was invited to perform at the Summer Festival in Palm Springs. Walking across the stage to the piano, I did what my teacher had advised. Pretend you're only playing for one person. That way you won't be so nervous. I glanced at my father, who sat in the front row, leaning his head just so, waiting. Then I closed my eyes, and began to play.

©2019 by Laila Lalami

According to the text, what does the narrator do as she walks across the stage?

A. She thinks about the differences between playing the piano alone and playing in a band.

B. She feels excitement about playing in a music festival for the first time.

C. She remembers how hard she has practiced for the performance.

D. She follows her teacher's advice about managing her nervousness.

1.14 bad15e98-4169-43d5-9421-374a6231ddfb · Easy

The following text is adapted from Sylvia Acevedo's 2018 memoir *Path to the Stars: My Journey from Girl Scout to Rocket Scientist.* The narrator is traveling by car with her family to Mexico City. Mario and Laura are her brother and sister.

> Mario and I played games to see how many different license plates we could spot, and Laura liked to look for children in the back seats of the cars we passed. We were used to the forty-five-minute drive to El Paso and familiar with the six-hour ride to Chihuahua, but I wondered what the long journey to Mexico City would be like.

©2018 by Sylvia Acevedo

According to the text, what did the narrator and Mario do while riding in the car?

A. They read books.

B. They sang songs.

C. They went to sleep.

D. They played games.

1.15 b07b52e9-c1ee-4177-bce8-9a5b35a6f12f · Easy

Ruth Asawa was an accomplished artist who worked in many art forms, including her unique tied-wire sculptures, but she was dedicated to more than the creation of art. Asawa also wanted to bring art to children in her hometown of San Francisco, California. To that end, in 1968 she cofounded the Alvarado School Arts Workshop, which brought works of art and artists into public schools, and in 1982 she helped found a San Francisco public arts high school, which was later named after her.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. Asawa inspired many other artists to share their work with students in public schools.

B. Asawa's unique sculptures were appreciated more by local art communities than they were nationwide.

C. Asawa's interest in art education prompted her to create art programs for students in San Francisco.

D. Asawa left a promising career as a sculptor to work as an art teacher in San Francisco schools.

1.16 b65b6bb1-ed51-4028-8bea-421ff84c160b · Easy

In the 1960s, Chavela Vargas became an unlikely star in ranchera, a style of traditional Mexican music. Most ranchera singers had clear, polished voices and performed with a full band. But Vargas accompanied her raspy voice with just her guitar. Dressed in men's trousers and a poncho, she would perform classic songs that had been written from a male point of view and were usually sung by men. She also altered those songs by performing them much more slowly than other ranchera singers did. The slower tempo allowed her to express the emotional quality of the lyrics more fully.

According to the text, what is one way that Vargas differed from other ranchera singers?

A. She possessed a voice that was clear and polished.

B. She avoided singing songs written from a male point of view.

C. She disliked performing classic songs.

D. She altered classic songs by slowing them down.

1.17 77e03ff0-a9f8-40fb-a56a-4dcb12d23e31 · Easy

Bicycles were first mass-produced in the late nineteenth century throughout Europe and North America, allowing individuals remarkable freedom to travel longer distances quickly and comfortably. This freedom, coupled with the affordability of the vehicle, made the bicycle immensely popular. Individuals were able to live farther from their workplaces, easily visit neighboring towns, and participate in new leisure and sport activities. Bicycling quickly became a popular social endeavor, with enthusiasts forming local cycling clubs to enjoy these newfound activities with others.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. The widespread adoption of the bicycle in the late nineteenth century provided new opportunities for people.

B. The affordability of the bicycle in the late nineteenth century made it the preferred way to travel.

C. The popularity of the bicycle in the late nineteenth century gave rise to the first cycling clubs.

D. The mass production of the bicycle in the late nineteenth century made it safer for people to use.

1.18 8f3764da-9e5e-4406-8b84-4c3a91358727 · Easy

The following text is from Jane Austen's 1811 novel *Sense and Sensibility*. Elinor lives with her younger sisters and her mother, Mrs. Dashwood.

> Elinor, this eldest daughter, whose advice was so effectual, possessed a strength of understanding, and coolness of judgment, which qualified her, though only nineteen, to be the counsellor of her mother, and enabled her frequently to counteract, to the advantage of them all, that eagerness of mind in Mrs. Dashwood which must generally have led to imprudence. She had an excellent heart;—her disposition was affectionate, and her feelings were strong; but she knew how to govern them: it was a knowledge which her mother had yet to learn; and which one of her sisters had resolved never to be taught.

According to the text, what is true about Elinor?

A. Elinor often argues with her mother but fails to change her mind.

B. Elinor can be overly sensitive with regard to family matters.

C. Elinor thinks her mother is a bad role model.

D. Elinor is remarkably mature for her age.

1.19 23b3d126-1b6f-4fe8-a602-d143e7a3e3e2 · Easy

The following text is from Shyam Selvadurai's 1994 novel *Funny Boy.* The seven-year-old narrator lives with his family in Sri Lanka. Radha Aunty is the narrator's aunt.

Radha Aunty, who was the youngest in my father's family, had left for America four years ago when I was three, and I could not remember what she looked like. I went into the corridor to look at the family photographs that were hung there. But all the pictures were old ones, taken when Radha Aunty was a baby or young girl. Try as I might, I couldn't get an idea of what she looked like now. My imagination, however, was quick to fill in this void.

©1994 by Shyam Selvadurai.

According to the text, why does the narrator consult some family photographs?

A. He wants to use the photographs as inspiration for a story he is writing.

B. He is curious about how his father dressed a long time ago.

C. He hopes the photographs will help him recall what his aunt looked like.

D. He wants to remind his aunt of an event that is shown in an old photograph.

1.20 f169ff49-6399-4c19-865e-7fa742c53258 · Easy

Oluwaseyi Moejoh cofounded U-recycle Initiative Africa when she was only a teenager. Moejoh and her team founded the organization to teach young people how their actions affect the environment and why recycling is important. For example, the organization put on an exhibit of art made using recycled materials.

According to the text, what is one reason Moejoh and others founded U-recycle Initiative Africa?

A. To bring attention to overlooked African artists

B. To teach young people why recycling is important

C. To help adults gain important outdoor skills

D. To give teenagers advice about starting businesses

1.21 4e06110f-0c9b-48ea-88ab-a1004353ab6d · Easy

Having written the impassioned call to arms “Letter to the Spanish Americans” in 1791, Peruvian intellectual Juan Pablo Viscardo y Guzmán is often considered a forerunner for the independence movements in Latin America. But Viscardo’s role in history would have remained insignificant were it not for Venezuelan revolutionary Francisco de Miranda, who was handed the unpublished letter after Viscardo’s death. Miranda not only helped circulate the letter, but his edits and footnotes to the text position Miranda as a central figure in the text’s creation.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. The original authorship of “Letter to the Spanish Americans” is disputed by contemporary historians.

B. The majority of the most eloquently stated arguments in “Letter to the Spanish Americans” were written by Miranda.

C. Miranda played a crucial role in influencing the content and distribution of “Letter to the Spanish Americans.”

D. “Letter to the Spanish Americans” persuaded many people in Latin America to pursue national independence.

1.22 21f5cc4a-939d-43ff-95ab-d7c0ea4718f1 · Easy

The following text is from David Barclay Moore's 2022 novel *Holler of the Fireflies*. The narrator has just arrived at summer camp, which is far away from his home.

> This place was different than I thought it would be. I'd never been somewhere like this before. I did feel scared, but also excited.

©2022 by David Barclay Moore

According to the text, how does the narrator feel about being at summer camp?

A. He feels overjoyed.

B. He feels peaceful.

C. He feels both scared and excited.

D. He feels both angry and jealous.

1.23 d490e4a5-bf54-48b3-a21c-27e521f53d3c · Easy

The following text is adapted from Johanna Spyri's 1881 novel *Heidi* (translated by Elisabeth Stork in 1915). Eight-year-old Heidi and her friend's grandmother are looking at some illustrated books.

> Heidi had come and was looking with wondering eyes at the splendid pictures in the large books, that Grandmama was showing her. Suddenly she screamed aloud, for there on the picture she saw a peaceful flock grazing on a green pasture. In the middle a shepherd was standing, leaning on his crook. The setting sun was shedding a golden light over everything. With glowing eyes Heidi devoured the scene.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. Heidi is upset until she sees a serene image of a pasture in one of Grandmama's books.

B. Heidi is delighted and fascinated by an image she sees in one of Grandmama's books.

C. Heidi is initially frightened by an image in one of Grandmama's books but quickly comes to appreciate its beauty.

D. Heidi is inspecting an image in one of Grandmama's books because she has never seen a shepherd with his sheep before.

1.24 dac67381-2a34-4b01-a6a1-41102f159d28 · Easy

Artist Justin Favela explained that he wanted to reclaim the importance of the piñata as a symbol in Latinx culture. To do so, he created numerous sculptures from strips of tissue paper, which is similar to the material used to create piñatas. In 2017, Favela created an impressive life-size piñata-like sculpture of the Gypsy Rose lowrider car, which was displayed at the Petersen Automotive Museum in Los Angeles, California. The Gypsy Rose lowrider was famously driven by Jesse Valadez, an early president of the Los Angeles Imperials Car Club.

According to the text, which piece of Favela's art was on display in the Petersen Automotive Museum in 2017?

A. A painting of Los Angeles

B. A sculpture of a lowrider car

C. A painting of a piñata

D. A sculpture of Jesse Valadez

1.25 77a2ee2e-2bee-4a40-a24b-c3515b3bb5ae · Easy

In the 1960s, Gloria Richardson led a movement to promote racial equality. Her involvement in this effort was inspired by her daughter, Donna Richardson. In 1961, Donna joined protests organized by the Student Nonviolent Coordinating Committee in Cambridge, Maryland. Following her daughter, Gloria joined these protests too. Gloria soon became the cochair of the Cambridge Nonviolent Action Committee. She was also the leader of what became known as the Cambridge movement.

According to the text, what did Gloria Richardson lead?

A. The Cambridge movement

B. Her daughter Donna's high school

C. Protests to support environmental protections

D. A new business in Cambridge, Maryland

1.26 3ef60e7e-2222-4c2c-80a1-2d4eec7abb4a · Easy

In the 1700s and 1800s, European composers experimented with volume in their musical works. They did so by increasing the number of musicians playing in the orchestra. For example, in some of his operas, German composer Richard Wagner added more horns, trombones, and tubas to the orchestra. With more instruments playing at the same time, the orchestra could play extremely loudly at key moments in his operas.

According to the text, how did Richard Wagner achieve moments of extremely high volume in his operas?

A. By moving the performances of his operas from outdoor stages to indoor ones

B. By increasing the number of musicians playing horns, trombones, and tubas in the orchestra

C. By building a concert hall whose shape would cause sounds to echo

D. By insisting that the singers undergo special training to sing for extended periods of time

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1.27 85b52d3b-001d-4ff1-81fd-e1742c8c00aa · Easy

To make her art more widely available, graphic artist Elizabeth Catlett turned to linocuts. In linocut printing, an artist carves an image into a sheet of linoleum to create a stamp that is used to mass-produce prints. In the linocut series *The Black Woman* (1946–1947), Catlett depicts the everyday experiences of Black women alongside the achievements of well-known Black women. This pairing invites the viewer to draw connections among the women. The linocut process enabled Catlett's work to reach a wide audience and supported her aim to unite Black women through her art.

According to the text, what is significant about Catlett's use of linocut printing?

A. Linocut printing involved using materials that were readily available to Catlett.

B. Linocut printing helped Catlett use art to connect people, especially Black women.

C. Catlett became commercially successful once she started using linocut printing.

D. Catlett was one of the first Black artists to use linocut printing.

1.28 6bf622a0-d5f7-48e3-bd49-df6a4cf0d266 · Easy

The average age at which people in the United States start businesses is 35. Economist Andrés Hincapié studied why young adults are relatively less likely to start businesses and whether there are ways to increase entrepreneurship in early adulthood. Hincapié found that one impediment is lack of knowledge about the practical details of how businesses are started; he further found that simply providing young adults with good informational resources on the topic significantly alleviates this problem.

Based on the text, what would Hincapié most likely say is a promising way to increase entrepreneurship in early adulthood?

A. Creating social networks of young adults who are interested in starting a business

B. Encouraging young adults to brainstorm business ideas

C. Providing young adults with practical information about how to start a business

D. Giving young adults training opportunities at a variety of businesses

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1.29 372d026d-316c-4dc0-a1e7-33878776e91c · Easy

Few animals are known to spit: among them are humans, cobras, and camels. But in January 2022 at a nature preserve in southern England, bird-watcher Clare Jacobs observed a gray seal spitting a jet of water at a white-tailed eagle flying overhead. Seals had never been seen spitting before. Biologist Sean Twiss, who studies gray seals, believes that the seal may have been attempting to scare the eagle away from a food source or that the seal may have just been playing.

Which choice best states the main topic of the text?

A. Bird-watching in southern England

B. A previously unseen behavior of gray seals

C. How white-tailed eagles defend their territory against other predators

D. Differences between gray seals and white-tailed eagles

1.30 03508ded-7e44-467a-b16b-93608113408c · Easy

The following text is adapted from Oscar Wilde's 1891 novel *The Picture of Dorian Gray*. Dorian Gray is taking his first look at a portrait that Hallward has painted of him.

> Dorian passed listlessly in front of his picture and turned towards it. When he saw it he drew back, and his cheeks flushed for a moment with pleasure. A look of joy came into his eyes, as if he had recognized himself for the first time. He stood there motionless and in wonder, dimly conscious that Hallward was speaking to him, but not catching the meaning of his words. The sense of his own beauty came on him like a revelation. He had never felt it before.

According to the text, what is true about Dorian?

A. He wants to know Hallward's opinion of the portrait.

B. He is delighted by what he sees in the portrait.

C. He prefers portraits to other types of paintings.

D. He is uncertain of Hallward's talent as an artist.

1.31 9cb7ff11-cb19-42f9-b8d2-f5191ec6866c · Easy

Hevea brasiliensis, a tree in the Amazon rainforest, is the world's main source of natural rubber. The tree produces a milky substance called latex that is used to make rubber. The bark of *Hevea brasiliensis* is helpful for the process of making rubber because it has a unique structure that makes it easy to collect latex. A network of tubes in the tree's inner bark helps the latex to flow out easily when people make small cuts into the bark.

What feature of *Hevea brasiliensis* does the text say is helpful for the process of making rubber?

A. Its latex produces rubber of an especially high quality.

B. Its bark has a unique structure that makes it easy to collect latex.

C. It is able to grow in a wide variety of climates around the world.

D. It is one of only two trees in the Amazon that produce latex.

1.32 c9b44f83-585f-4a08-9ae7-4a64f2d63322 · Easy

Stores often play background music to create a pleasant shopping experience. Based on a survey, Amir Manzoor found that such music was linked to reduced enjoyment among customers. Manzoor thinks that one explanation for this result is that the surveyed customers may have wanted to finish their shopping as quickly as possible. They therefore weren't focused on enjoying the experience. It's possible that background music could improve the experience of other customers whose main goal is to have a good time while they shop.

Based on the text, which research question was Manzoor's study most likely intended to answer?

A. Does the volume of a store's background music affect how much time customers spend in the store?

B. How does the use of background music in stores affect customers' shopping experience?

C. Do customers spend more money when shopping for music in stores or online?

D. What genres of music do customers prefer to listen to while they are shopping?

1.33 e6590d5e-2b45-4887-b784-5c8601dc008e · Easy

The following text is adapted from Edith Nesbit's 1906 novel *The Railway Children*.

> Mother did not spend all her time in paying dull [visits] to dull ladies, and sitting dully at home waiting for dull ladies to pay [visits] to her. She was almost always there, ready to play with the children, and read to them, and help them to do their home-lessons. Besides this she used to write stories for them while they were at school, and read them aloud after tea, and she always made up funny pieces of poetry for their birthdays and for other great occasions.

According to the text, what is true about Mother?

A. She wishes that more ladies would visit her.

B. Birthdays are her favorite special occasion.

C. She creates stories and poems for her children.

D. Reading to her children is her favorite activity.

1.34 1b252562-3bec-43c2-ac49-bb173f19ca83 · Easy

In 1935 Hallie Flanagan was chosen to lead the Federal Theatre Project (FTP). This project was part of the new Works Progress Administration (WPA), a program created by President Franklin D. Roosevelt to provide jobs for unemployed people during the Great Depression. As the director of the FTP, Flanagan created jobs for over 12,500 performers, designers, and other theater professionals across the country. She also kept ticket prices low for the shows they staged, which meant that many people could afford to experience theater for the first time.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. Jobs provided by the FTP were intended mainly for performers, designers, and other theater professionals.

B. President Roosevelt created the WPA to provide jobs for unemployed people.

C. During the Great Depression, many people couldn't afford to buy theater tickets.

D. As the director of the FTP, Flanagan succeeded in creating many jobs and introducing people to theater.

1.35 0a755181-a4cc-4396-b977-da1608faf80f · Easy

When fashion designer Lloyd Henri Kiva New opened his store in Scottsdale, Arizona, in 1945, he quickly became known for creating delicately crafted leather goods, like belts and hats. He was perhaps most renowned for his colorful handbags, which he made by hand using a long and painstaking process. As he gained more customers, New began using sewing machines and other tools to help him produce bags more efficiently, though he continued to handcraft the crucial details that made each bag unique.

Based on the text, what would have been the most likely consequence if New had not begun using sewing machines?

A. He would have been unable to ensure that each bag included unique, handcrafted details.

B. He would have struggled to meet the increasing demand for his bags.

C. He would have had to individually design each bag he produced.

D. He would not have been able to generate as much interest in his bags.

1.36 157a66e4-2393-45c7-b129-cabbbf204d2e · Easy

Psychologists wanted to test how young children think about rewards and fairness. In an experiment, two teachers handed out rewards while children (ages four to six) watched. The teachers gave out the same number of rewards, but one of them counted the rewards out loud. The children were then asked who was fairer. 73% chose the teacher who counted. The psychologists think that counting showed the children that the teacher wanted to be fair. The children may have believed that the teacher who did not count did not care about fairness.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. Psychologists think children cannot understand the concept of fairness until they are six years old.

B. An experiment found that counting out loud is the best way to teach mathematical concepts to children.

C. Psychologists think young children expect to be rewarded when the children show that they care about fairness.

D. An experiment showed that the way rewards are given out may affect whether young children think the situation is fair.

1.37 a757bf98-d9a5-4e82-b9a7-849c764338f2 · Easy

Microplastics are pieces of plastic that are smaller than a grain of rice. These small plastics can be found in large quantities in ocean waters. Ecologist Jessica Reichert and her team are studying the role reef-building corals have in capturing microplastics from ocean waters. Through research, her team has found that these corals may be storing up to 20 million kilograms of microplastics each year in their skeletons and tissues.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. Ecologists are interested in learning more about how certain corals build large reefs.

B. Questions remain around the impact certain corals have on ocean ecosystems.

C. Microplastics are small pieces of plastic that can be found in ocean waters.

D. Ecologists predict that corals store large amounts of microplastics from ocean waters.

1.38 caf0a82a-425b-4a35-aa35-5c478fe13afb · Easy

In 2022, researchers rediscovered ancient indigenous glyphs, or drawings, on the walls of a cave in Alabama. The cave's ceiling was only a few feet high, affording no position from which the glyphs, being as wide as ten feet, could be viewed or photographed in their entirety. However, the researchers used a technique called photogrammetry to assemble numerous photos of the walls into a 3D model. They then worked with representatives of tribes originally from the region, including the Chickasaw Nation, to understand the significance of the animal and humanoid figures adorning the cave.

According to the text, what challenge did the researchers have to overcome to examine the glyphs?

A. The cave was so remote that the researchers couldn't easily reach it.

B. Some of the glyphs were so faint that they couldn't be photographed.

C. The researchers were unable to create a 3D model of the cave.

D. The cave's dimensions prevented the researchers from fully viewing the glyphs.

1.39 90758981-860d-4a7d-a2eb-6720666df2eb · Easy

The following text is adapted from Edgar Allan Poe's 1849 story "Landor's Cottage."

> During a pedestrian trip last summer, through one or two of the river counties of New York, I found myself, as the day declined, somewhat embarrassed about the road I was pursuing. The land undulated very remarkably; and my path, for the last hour, had wound about and about so confusedly, in its effort to keep in the valleys, that I no longer knew in what direction lay the sweet village of B——, where I had determined to stop for the night.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. The narrator remembers a trip he took and admits to getting lost.

B. The narrator recalls fond memories of a journey that he took through some beautiful river counties.

C. The narrator describes what he saw during a long trip through a frequently visited location.

D. The narrator explains the difficulties he encountered on a trip and how he overcame them.

1.40 2726ae9a-1dbe-4d18-bd8b-ee2cc3808a0d · Easy

Arthropods—brine shrimp, hawk moths, and many other invertebrate animals—have a nervous system made up of a brain, nerve cord, and other nerves. Researchers have gained insights about this system in ancient arthropods from traces found in various fossils. For example, in a study of two fossils of the extinct arthropod species *Mollisonia symmetrica*, Javier Ortega-Hernández, James Weaver, and team observed clear signs of a nerve cord. They also saw possible indications of a synganglion, a brain-like mass of nerves. Researchers hope to identify more features of the nervous systems of prehistoric arthropods as additional fossils are found.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. There are several similarities between the brains of hawk moths and the brains of brine shrimp.

B. Fossil evidence can contribute to the understanding of the nervous system in ancient arthropods.

C. Newly discovered fossils suggest that ancient hawk moths and ancient brine shrimp had spines.

D. Researchers need to focus on finding more fossils of ancient arthropods.

1.41 186b2a9e-0ace-47a7-b2d5-4db88f390327 · Easy

When Kenyan writer Ngũgĩ wa Thiong'o, who had previously published four novels in English, began writing in his native language, Gĩkũyũ, in the 1970s, several fellow writers and critics cautioned that doing so might make his works inaccessible outside his own community. Some noted that Kiswahili—widely spoken in Kenya and elsewhere in Africa—would be a more practical choice. Rejecting their arguments, Ngũgĩ went on to author dozens of acclaimed works in Gĩkũyũ that have been translated into a total of more than thirty languages.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. The reaction to Ngũgĩ's rejection of English illustrates that some literary experts believe that fame is most easily gained by writing in a widely understood language, such as Gĩkũyũ.

B. Although Ngũgĩ insisted on publishing his first works in Gĩkũyũ, they have since been translated into many other languages.

C. Although Ngũgĩ's decision to write in Gĩkũyũ was met with some skepticism, it didn't prevent him from achieving literary success.

D. In the 1970s, Ngũgĩ became convinced that literature ought to be written in authors' native languages, and he proceeded to publish many works in Gĩkũyũ.

1.42 b280ba71-e914-4119-8335-a7c8eb92768c · Medium

Paleontologist Alan Tennyson and colleagues studied fossil bones found in New Zealand that are more than 55 million years old. The researchers determined that the fossil bones belonged to two previously unknown species of prehistoric penguins. Moreover, they estimated that one of the two penguin species was more than three times the size of the emperor penguin, which is the largest penguin species that exists today.

Based on the text, which choice best describes the two previously unknown penguin species?

A. They are frequently studied by paleontologists.

B. They are no longer living species.

C. They were smaller than penguin species that exist today.

D. They spent little of their lives in water.

1.43 2feba5ee-68da-40e5-9ac9-a2d6595ea46b · Medium

The following text is adapted from Countee Cullen's 1926 poem "Thoughts in a Zoo."

They in their cruel traps, and we in ours,

Survey each other's rage, and pass the hours

Commiserating each the other's woe,

To mitigate his own pain's fiery glow.

Man could but little proffer in exchange

Save that his cages have a larger range.

That lion with his lordly, untamed heart

Has in some man his human counterpart,

Some lofty soul in dreams and visions wrapped,

But in the stifling flesh securely trapped.

Based on the text, what challenge do humans sometimes experience?

A. They cannot effectively tame certain wild animals because of a lack of compassion.

B. They cannot focus on setting attainable goals because of a lack of motivation.

C. They quickly become frustrated when faced with difficult tasks because of a lack of self-control.

D. They have aspirations that cannot be fulfilled because of certain limitations.

1.44 7fac536f-bfa4-41d3-b7ea-1adb6680cd47 · Medium

Using the Stratospheric Observatory for Infrared Astronomy (SOFIA), a team of astronomers mapped out the magnetic field of G47, one of the Milky Way's galactic bones (dense clouds of gas and dust that run through the middle of the arm of a spiral galaxy). Surprisingly, the map revealed a magnetic field with no clear pattern or direction. The researchers had expected the magnetic field to be similar to the more uniform fields seen in galactic bones in other arms of the Milky Way.

According to the text, what was surprising about the researchers' mapping of the magnetic field of galactic bone G47?

A. It showed a weaker magnetic field than expected.

B. It implied that previous mappings of the magnetic field were inaccurate.

C. It produced magnetic field measurements similar to those for other galactic bones.

D. It revealed a magnetic field that wasn't uniform.

1.45 7e4e4382-e8f2-4072-ab9e-42dfb93b9837 · Medium

In many of his sculptures, artist Richard Hunt uses broad forms rather than extreme accuracy to hint at specific people or ideas. In his first major work, *Arachne* (1956), Hunt constructed the mythical character Arachne, a weaver who was changed into a spider, by welding bits of steel together into something that, although vaguely human, is strange and machine-like. And his large bronze sculpture *The Light of Truth* (2021) commemorates activist and journalist Ida B. Wells using mainly flowing, curved pieces of metal that create stylized flame.

Which choice best states the text's main idea about Hunt?

A. He often depicts the subjects of his sculptures using an unrealistic style.

B. He uses different kinds of materials depending on what kind of sculpture he plans to create.

C. He tends to base his art on important historical figures rather than on fictional characters.

D. He has altered his approach to sculpture over time, and his works have become increasingly abstract.

1.46 73bf8fb7-a095-496b-b9f5-109b6af2d221 · Medium

In present-day Chiapas, Mexico, archaeologist Robert Rosenswig, remote-sensing specialist Ricardo López-Torrijos, and colleagues have located 41 smaller settlements surrounding the ancient Mesoamerican city of Izapa. The researchers have concluded that these settlements were culturally linked to Izapa because each of the settlements is the same age and configured in the same manner as Izapa, with a pyramid to the north and a plaza to the south. Their shared structural orientation suggests that residents of the settlements likely performed some of the same cultural ceremonies as residents in Izapa did.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. Researchers have determined that the arrangement of Izapa's structures was based on those of other nearby settlements.

B. Cultural ceremonies in Izapa seem to have played a more important role for its residents than those in smaller, surrounding settlements did.

C. Although archaeologists have learned much about Izapa over years of research, they have only recently found the smaller settlements that surrounded it.

D. Researchers have inferred that Izapa was related to the smaller settlements that surrounded it based in part on the similarity of their construction.

1.47 8ae4f9b3-f842-46f5-bc37-368fe0f440ca · Medium

The following text is adapted from Jack London's 1903 novel *The Call of the Wild*. Buck is a sled dog living with John Thornton in Yukon, Canada.

> Thornton alone held [Buck]. The rest of mankind was as nothing. Chance travellers might praise or pet him; but he was cold under it all, and from a too demonstrative man he would get up and walk away. When Thornton's partners, Hans and Pete, arrived on the long-expected raft, Buck refused to notice them till he learned they were close to Thornton; after that he tolerated them in a passive sort of way, accepting favors from them as though he favored them by accepting.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. Buck has become less social since he began living with Thornton.

B. Buck mistrusts humans and does his best to avoid them.

C. Buck has been especially well liked by most of Thornton's friends.

D. Buck holds Thornton in higher regard than any other person.

1.48 eddf2dbd-c0cb-4ca1-bea8-c6e522b4c743 · Medium

During the World War II era, some Mexican American women adopted a striking new look called *pachuca* style. They wore altered men's jackets or zoot suits (wide-legged, long-coated suits) and dramatic makeup, and they combed their hair into high, rounded shapes. Some people criticized *pachuca* style, saying it was dangerous and women should dress traditionally. But historians see things differently. They see *pachuca* style as a form of rebellion against the era's rigid social expectations for women. They say that it showed a desire for self-expression and freedom on the part of women who adopted the style.

According to the text, how do historians view *pachuca* style?

A. They think that *pachuca* style was such a popular trend that it continues to influence fashion in the United States to the present day.

B. They think that *pachuca* style was a way for some Mexican American women to express themselves and resist strict social expectations.

C. They think that *pachuca* style was celebrated because it enabled some Mexican American women to show their support for the United States during World War II.

D. They think that *pachuca* style was similar to other fashion trends that different groups of women adopted in the same period.

1.49 08ef7a18-0b11-4f61-87fc-ce1909ad2b65 · Medium

Archaeologists have discovered a runestone in Norway that may contain the earliest example of written words in Scandinavia. Carbon dating at the discovery site revealed that the stone was likely carved between 1 and 250 CE. Runologist Kristel Zilmer believes the stone will be helpful in learning more about the use of runic alphabets in early Iron Age Scandinavia.

Which choice best states the main topic of the text?

A. Battles of the Iron Age

B. A runestone found in Norway

C. A new method for dating rock samples

D. The research interests of Kristel Zilmer

1.50 fbf6b996-3607-41ed-a39c-163d8c8c394c · Medium

The ancient writing system used in the Maya kingdoms of southern Mexico and Central America had a symbol for the number zero. The earliest known example of the symbol dates to more than 2,000 years ago. At that time, almost none of the writing systems elsewhere in the world possessed a zero symbol. And the use of zero in Mexico and Central America may be even more ancient. Some historians suggest that Maya mathematicians inherited it from the Olmec civilization, which flourished in the region 2,400–3,600 years ago.

According to the text, what do some historians suggest about Maya civilization?

A. Maya civilization acquired the use of zero from the Olmec civilization.

B. Maya civilization respected its historians more than it respected its mathematicians.

C. Maya civilization was highly secretive about its intellectual achievements.

D. Maya civilization tried to introduce its writing system to other civilizations.

1.51 30c2d8b8-5292-4af7-b701-0109496da1a5 · Medium

A contraction of “you all,” the pronoun “y’all” has long been used as a plural version of “you” in the South and in Black communities around the US. In recent decades, most other English-speaking communities in the US have begun to use “y’all.” What explains its rise in popularity? Many varieties of English have no pronoun that specifically addresses more than one person and instead must use “you” to address both one person and more than one. But “y’all” always refers to two or more people. As a result, it conveys the speaker’s meaning more precisely than “you” can.

Which question does the text most directly attempt to answer?

A. How many other plural versions of the pronoun “you” are there in English, besides “y’all”?

B. Why has the pronoun “y’all” become more widely used in the US?

C. When was the first recorded use of the pronoun “y’all” in the English language?

D. Is “y’all” commonly used in English-speaking regions of the world besides the US?

1.52 4d2152ad-3e95-4ca9-91a8-423758f25623 · Medium

Since its completion in 2014, Bosco Verticale (Vertical Forest)—a pair of residential towers in Milan, Italy, covered by vegetation—has become a striking symbol of environmental sustainability in architecture. Stefano Boeri intended his design, which features balconies that are home to hundreds of trees, to serve as a model for promoting urban biodiversity. However, the concept has faced skepticism: critics note that although the trees used in Bosco Verticale were specifically cultivated for the project, it's too early to tell if they can thrive in this unusual setting.

According to the text, why are some critics skeptical of the concept behind Bosco Verticale?

A. Some essential aspects of Bosco Verticale's design are difficult to adapt to locations other than Milan.

B. The plant life on Bosco Verticale ended up being less varied than Boeri had envisioned it would be.

C. The construction of Bosco Verticale was no less environmentally damaging than the construction of more conventional buildings is.

D. It is unclear whether Bosco Verticale can support the plant life included in its design.

1.53 85c19ad6-e14d-43d4-9d45-def4e74635b2 · Medium

Choctaw/Cherokee artist Jeffrey Gibson turns punching bags used by boxers into art by decorating them with beadwork and elements of Native dressmaking. These elements include leather fringe and jingles, the metal cones that cover the dresses worn in the jingle dance, a women's dance of the Ojibwe people. Thus, Gibson combines an object commonly associated with masculinity (a punching bag) with art forms traditionally practiced by women in most Native communities (beadwork and dressmaking). In this way, he rejects the division of male and female gender roles.

Which choice best describes Gibson's approach to art, as presented in the text?

A. He draws from traditional Native art forms to create his original works.

B. He has been influenced by Native and non-Native artists equally.

C. He finds inspiration from boxing in designing the dresses he makes.

D. He rejects expectations about color and pattern when incorporating beadwork.

1.54 6bf1a887-da03-4cdf-b053-cc4a2e176641 · Medium

In 1934 physicist Eugene Wigner posited the existence of a crystal consisting entirely of electrons in a honeycomb-like structure. The so-called Wigner crystal remained largely conjecture, however, until Feng Wang and colleagues announced in 2021 that they had captured an image of one. The researchers trapped electrons between two semiconductors and then cooled the apparatus, causing the electrons to settle into a crystalline structure. By inserting an ultrathin sheet of graphene above the crystal, the researchers obtained an impression—the first visual confirmation of the Wigner crystal.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. Researchers have obtained the most definitive evidence to date of the existence of the Wigner crystal.

B. Researchers have identified an innovative new method for working with unusual crystalline structures.

C. Graphene is the most important of the components required to capture an image of a Wigner crystal.

D. It's difficult to acquire an image of a Wigner crystal because of the crystal's honeycomb structure.

1.55 d6a68288-df99-46df-af06-1d642b22ed89 · Medium

The following text is from Mark Haber's 2022 novel *Saint Sebastian's Abyss*. The narrator and Schmidt are both art critics.

> When my first wife admitted to Schmidt over dinner that she didn't find art, painting in particular, especially compelling, Schmidt winced, set down his fork, and sighed dramatically; he then excused himself, explaining an appointment he'd forgotten about had suddenly and inexplicably been remembered, while making it abundantly clear there was no appointment at all.

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Based on the text, what is notable about Schmidt's behavior?

A. Schmidt is only given to theatrical behavior when in the company of the narrator and his first wife.

B. Schmidt's absentmindedness regarding his schedule is uncharacteristic of him.

C. Schmidt's departure is occasioned by the resumption of a previous disagreement with the narrator's first wife about a particular painting.

D. Schmidt conveys his feelings about one of his dining companions without explicitly stating them.

1.56 c41ebd08-a19c-44e2-a621-3e50ac34dcd2 · Medium

A common assumption among art historians is that the invention of photography in the mid-nineteenth century displaced the painted portrait in the public consciousness. The diminishing popularity of the portrait miniature, which coincided with the rise of photography, seems to support this claim. However, photography's impact on the portrait miniature may be overstated. Although records from art exhibitions in the Netherlands from 1820 to 1892 show a decrease in the number of both full-sized and miniature portraits submitted, this trend was established before the invention of photography.

Based on the text, what can be concluded about the diminishing popularity of the portrait miniature in the nineteenth century?

A. Factors other than the rise of photography may be more directly responsible for the portrait miniature's decline.

B. Although portrait miniatures became less common than photographs, they were widely regarded as having more artistic merit.

C. The popularity of the portrait miniature likely persisted for longer than art historians have assumed.

D. As demand for portrait miniatures decreased, portrait artists likely shifted their creative focus to photography.

1.57 e5ffa0e4-1fea-42ae-b997-44eed4a8e733 · Medium

Utah is home to Pando, a colony of about 47,000 quaking aspen trees that all share a single root system. Pando is one of the largest single organisms by mass on Earth, but ecologists are worried that its growth is declining in part because of grazing by animals. The ecologists say that strong fences could prevent deer from eating young trees and help Pando start thriving again.

According to the text, why are ecologists worried about Pando?

A. It isn’t growing at the same rate it used to.

B. It isn’t producing young trees anymore.

C. It can’t grow into new areas because it is blocked by fences.

D. Its root system can’t support many more new trees.

1.58 8867acef-9776-4099-b6bc-f5059e8a9574 · Medium

Biologists have predicted that birds' feather structures vary with habitat temperature, but this hadn't been tested in mountain environments. Ornithologist Sahas Barve studied feathers from 249 songbird species inhabiting different elevations—and thus experiencing different temperatures—in the Himalayan Mountains. He found that feathers of high-elevation species not only have a greater proportion of warming downy sections to flat and smooth sections than do feathers of low-elevation species, but high-elevation species' feathers also tend to be longer, providing a thicker layer of insulation.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. Barve's investigation shows that some species of Himalayan songbirds have evolved feathers that better regulate body temperature than do the feathers of other species, contradicting previous predictions.

B. Barve found an association between habitat temperature and feather structure among Himalayan songbirds, lending new support to a general prediction.

C. Barve discovered that songbirds have adapted to their environment by growing feathers without flat and smooth sections, complicating an earlier hypothesis.

D. The results of Barve's study suggest that the ability of birds to withstand cold temperatures is determined more strongly by feather length than feather structure, challenging an established belief.

1.59 42f01cde-27fe-4251-a0d8-7d945d736aff · Medium

Archaeologists have observed similarities in the tools, such as bidirectional blades, uncovered at the Neolithic-period Mesopotamian settlement of Çayönü Tepesi and those uncovered at roughly contemporaneous settlements elsewhere in Southwest Asia, including those in the South Levant, Central Anatolia, and Central Zagros. Although similarities in tools could be attributed to imitative behavior or trade, Nefize Ezgi Altınışık et al. found evidence of genetic affinity among the populations of Çayönü Tepesi, Central Anatolia, the South Levant, and—to a lesser extent—Central Zagros.

Information in the text best supports which statement about the finding made by Altınışık et al.?

A. It implies that people and tools likely arrived in Çayönü Tepesi from settlements in Central Anatolia and the South Levant at an earlier time than they did from settlements in Central Zagros.

B. It raises the possibility that similarities in the design of tools found at Neolithic settlements in Southwest Asia emerged due to population blending between those settlements.

C. It suggests that in the Neolithic period, people in the South Levant and Central Anatolia imitated tool designs originating in Çayönü Tepesi more frequently than people in Central Zagros did.

D. It helps explain why contemporaneous Neolithic peoples in Southwest Asia had similar tools but lacked other obvious cultural similarities.

1.60 176cf9b7-f8b5-4194-9593-f60ba7a78ffb · Medium

The following text is adapted from Robert Louis Stevenson's 1883 novel *Treasure Island*. Bill is a sailor staying at the Admiral Benbow, an inn run by the narrator's parents.

Every day when [Bill] came back from his stroll he would ask if any seafaring men had gone by along the road. At first we thought it was the want of company of his own kind that made him ask this question, but at last we began to see he was desirous to avoid them. When a seaman did [stay] at the Admiral Benbow (as now and then some did) he would look in at him through the curtained door before he entered the parlour; and he was always sure to be as silent as a mouse when any such was present.

According to the text, why does Bill regularly ask about "seafaring men"?

A. He's hoping to find an old friend and fellow sailor.

B. He's trying to secure a job as part of the crew on a new ship.

C. He isn't sure that other guests at the inn will be welcoming of sailors.

D. He doesn't want to encounter any other sailor unexpectedly.

1.61 7e52fc97-3448-479e-8f83-6d659d404c11 · Medium

The following text is from Ahmet Hamdi Tanpinar's 1961 novel *The Time Regulation Institute* (translated from the Turkish in 2014 by Maureen Freely and Alexander Dawe). The narrator was once involved with the Time Regulation Institute, a fictional bureaucracy that regulates the time of Turkey's clocks.

> I may be the most humble and absurd man in the world and, as my wife says, the most slovenly creature you may ever meet—that is, before the founding of our institute—but I did come to know a truly great man who possessed a natural genius for invention. I spent years at his side. I watched the way he worked. I witnessed how an idea would suddenly catch fire in his mind and take shape, like a tree sprouting shoots and branches, before coming into being.

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Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. A person was fortunate enough to have found love despite his obvious shortcomings.

B. An exceptionally talented person professes humility to avoid intimidating others.

C. A person appreciates the extensive time he passed in the company of someone he deeply admired.

D. A truly brilliant person lets ideas mature in his mind before expressing them aloud.

1.62 9398bf21-3d5c-4477-aa8b-53f600fa4ea1 · Medium

Businesses selling clothing and other fashion items face obstacles in trying to forecast how much product to order: tastes and styles change quickly, while manufacturing clothing takes a significant amount of time. Researchers Youran Fu and Marshall Fisher have found that combining sellers' own data with information gathered from social media can dramatically improve the accuracy of such forecasts—by 24 to 57 percent in the cases they directly studied. Better predictions mean demand is easier to meet without retailers becoming overstocked.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. Using multiple data sources can enhance the ability of sellers in the fashion industry to anticipate demand.

B. Social media is revolutionizing how both sellers and researchers view the fashion industry.

C. Becoming overstocked is the main preoccupation of sellers trying to forecast demand for fashion items.

D. Retailers can use their own data to accurately predict how tastes and styles are evolving.

1.63 bf142dce-600d-4e0d-b6fc-80d7f0ae8ea8 · Medium

A subject of much speculation, distinctive sets of parallel ridges mark the icy crust of Europa, Jupiter's smallest moon. Researchers now claim that the ridges' formation mechanism mirrors that of a strikingly similar pair on Greenland's ice sheet. There, surface water seeped through fissures in the sheet and formed a water pocket that subsequently disrupted the overlying ice, forcing fragments of it upward and outward into peaks, as the pocket froze and expanded. Although Europa lacks liquid surface water, the same process could be driven by the moon's subsurface ocean.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. Researchers think that the ridges on Europa and the ridges in Greenland may have been formed by the same process even though Europa, unlike Greenland, doesn't have liquid water on its surface.

B. The primary difference between the ridges on Europa and the ridges in Greenland is that unlike the Europa ridges, the Greenland ridges are parallel.

C. The pair of ridges found on Greenland's ice sheet appear to have formed long before the recently discovered sets of ridges on Europa formed.

D. Researchers don't understand why Europa is marked by so many sets of ridges when the moon doesn't have any liquid water on its surface that could have collected and expanded under the icy crust.

1.64 21ab62c2-23da-4135-9ac5-3dbef25ef6fb · Medium

At over a thousand pages across two volumes, *The Fifty-Year Mission*, compiled by Edward Gross and Mark A. Altman, is presented as the "complete, uncensored, unauthorized oral history" as told by the people behind the media franchise *Star Trek*. The work aspires to be comprehensive by, for example, including accounts from cast and crew members of every *Star Trek* television series and film to date. But while *The Fifty-Year Mission* is clearly a unique and valuable resource, it has a shortcoming common among oral histories: it lacks a clear authorial point of view that could otherwise unite the various accounts into a cohesive whole.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. The compilers of *The Fifty-Year Mission* had lofty goals for their oral history of the *Star Trek* franchise, but the published work lacks information about many key events in the franchise's history.

B. *The Fifty-Year Mission* includes more accounts from people involved with *Star Trek* television shows than it does from people involved with *Star Trek* films.

C. The large amount of material compiled into *The Fifty-Year Mission* is surprising given that many of the people involved in the *Star Trek* franchise did not participate in the oral history project.

D. *The Fifty-Year Mission* represents a worthwhile attempt to thoroughly recount the history of the *Star Trek* franchise, but its approach has an important limitation.

1.65 50a97041-1bb7-41a5-ad91-9edb332c7d6b · Medium

Philadelphia's Black Pearl Chamber Orchestra, founded by Jeri Lynne Johnson, performs classical music, from well-known compositions by Beethoven to contemporary works by Jessie Montgomery. For the orchestra's iConduct! program, Johnson invites community members to learn some basic elements of conducting and then experience conducting the Black Pearl orchestra themselves.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. The Black Pearl orchestra performs music from all over the world but mostly performs music composed by Philadelphians.

B. Johnson founded the Black Pearl orchestra to perform classical music by contemporary artist Jessie Montgomery.

C. The Black Pearl orchestra gives community members the chance to both listen to and participate in classical music performance.

D. Johnson has community members conduct an orchestra to demonstrate how difficult the task is.

1.66 fa058d98-6bf6-4108-bf3c-48890f6373ff · Medium

To understand how Paleolithic artists navigated dark caves, archaeologist Mª Ángeles Medina-Alcaide and her team tested different lighting methods in a cave in Spain using replicas of artifacts found in European caves with art. They used three different Paleolithic light sources—torches, animal-fat lamps, and fireplaces—determining that each likely had a specific purpose. For instance, the team learned that the animal-fat lamps were less useful than torches while walking because the lamps didn't illuminate the cave floor.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. Medina-Alcaide and her team's study demonstrated that fireplaces were essential to the creators of Paleolithic cave art.

B. Medina-Alcaide and her team discovered that Paleolithic cave artists in Spain used animal-fat lamps more often than they used torches.

C. Medina-Alcaide and her team were reluctant to draw many conclusions from their study because of the difficulty they had replicating light sources based on known artifacts.

D. Medina-Alcaide and her team tested Paleolithic light sources and learned some details about how Paleolithic artists traveled within dark caves.

1.67 8966b09b-f9e6-47d0-9cfe-4335f223629d · Medium

The ice melted on a Norwegian mountain during a particularly warm summer in 2019, revealing a 1,700-year-old sandal to a mountaineer looking for artifacts. The sandal would normally have degraded quickly, but it was instead well preserved for centuries by the surrounding ice. According to archaeologist Espen Finstad and his team, the sandal, like those worn by imperial Romans, wouldn't have offered any protection from the cold in the mountains, so some kind of insulation, like fabric or animal skin, would have needed to be worn on the feet with the sandal.

What does the text indicate about the discovery of the sandal?

A. Temperatures contributed to both protecting and revealing the sandal.

B. The discovery revealed that the Roman Empire had more influence on Norway than archaeologists previously assumed.

C. Archaeologists would have found the sandal eventually without help from the general public.

D. The sandal would have degraded if it hadn't been removed from the ice.

1.68 c839816d-7f7e-4300-814f-1545276bc90a · Medium

For centuries, the widespread acknowledgment of the involvement of the cerebellum—a dense brain structure in vertebrates—in coordinating motor control in humans has hindered recognition of other possible functions of the structure. Neuroscience research from the last two decades now suggests that the cerebellum regulates emotion and social behavior, and recent research by Ilaria Carta and colleagues has identified a pathway connecting the cerebellum to a center for motivation and reward processing known as the ventral tegmental area (VTA).

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

A. The recent verification of a pathway between the VTA and the cerebellum confirms the cerebellum's long-suspected role in motor coordination.

B. Recent advances in the field of neuroscience have challenged widely accepted claims about the function of a pathway connecting the VTA and the cerebellum.

C. The cerebellum has primarily been thought to regulate motor functioning, but in recent years neuroscience researchers have been uncovering additional functions.

D. Technological limitations have historically hindered the study of the cerebellum, but the recent development of new technologies has led to greater insights into its functions.

1.69 d79cda6b-8ba1-4775-a193-020ecb1ed970 · Medium

To protect themselves when being attacked, hagfish—jawless marine animals that resemble eels—will release large quantities of slimy, mucus-like threads. Because these threads are unusually strong and elastic, scientist Atsuko Negishi and her colleagues have been trying to recreate them in a lab as an eco-friendly alternative to petroleum-based fibers that are often used in fabrics. The researchers want to reproduce the threads in the lab because farming hagfish for their slime would be expensive and potentially harmful to the hagfish.

Which choice best states the text's main idea?

A. The slimy threads that hagfish release might help researchers create a new kind of fabric.

B. Hagfish have inspired researchers to develop a new petroleum-based fabric.

C. Hagfish are not well suited to being raised in captivity.

D. The ability of hagfish to slime their attackers compensates for their being jawless.